Standard Precautions, Transmission Risk, and Safe Injections

NURSING · nursing-foundations · BoardPrep lesson v2

Official examination scope

PRC Resolution No. 10 s. 2025 adopts the enhanced Nurses Licensure Examination TOS for November 2025 and later schedules. This lesson selects infection-prevention principles for nursing practice. Follow current public-health guidance, patient condition, product instructions, and facility policy; no frequency claim is made.

Learning objectives

- Apply Standard Precautions to every patient encounter and match PPE to anticipated exposure.
- Determine when a suspected or confirmed transmission risk requires added precautions under
- current guidance.
- Protect patients by maintaining hand hygiene, equipment controls, and single-use sterile
- injection technique.

1. Start with Standard Precautions

Prerequisite: assess the task and likely contact with blood, body fluids, mucous membranes, non-intact skin, contaminated equipment, and the care environment. Standard Precautions apply to all patients in every care setting, regardless of known infection status. They include hand hygiene, safe injection practices, environmental and equipment controls, respiratory hygiene, and PPE selected for anticipated exposure. Gloves do not replace hand hygiene; clean hands at the indicated care moments and after PPE removal.

2. Add measures for transmission risk

When a suspected or confirmed condition calls for additional controls, add the current contact, droplet, or airborne pathway to Standard Precautions. Confirm the clinical syndrome or organism, setting, room controls, respiratory protection, equipment plan, and transport instructions in the current facility protocol. Requirements can vary with the pathogen and task; do not infer a complete PPE or room plan from a disease label alone.

3. Match PPE and equipment to the task

Before suctioning, close care, or handling contaminated equipment, identify the anticipated exposure and splash or aerosol risks, then prepare the indicated PPE, hand hygiene, equipment, disposal, and reprocessing steps. Use dedicated equipment or clean and reprocess reusable items as required. A procedure name alone does not determine the entire plan; follow the patient’s current precautions and facility procedure.

4. Keep injections aseptic

Use a new sterile needle and syringe for each patient and each injection. Never reuse a syringe or use a used needle to enter a medication vial or solution container. Use aseptic technique for vial access and follow product labeling and facility rules for storage and discard. A multidose vial does not make used injection equipment safe to reuse.

Prepare to suction a patient on contact precautions

Question: What should the nurse check before entering?
1. Confirm current isolation instructions and expected contact with secretions and equipment.
2. Select PPE and hand-hygiene steps required by the task and facility protocol.
3. Prepare equipment, disposal, and any room or transport controls.
Answer: Verify exposure risk, PPE, hand hygiene, equipment, disposal, and the current precaution pathway.

Check: The plan includes routine Standard Precautions and additional contact controls.

Access a multidose vial

Question: What prevents syringe-mediated transmission?
1. Use a new sterile needle and syringe for the patient and injection.
2. Do not re-enter the vial with used equipment.
3. Follow product labeling and facility rules for storage and discard.
Answer: Use single-use sterile injection equipment and an aseptic vial-access process.
Check: Needle and syringe are not shared between patients or reused for another vial entry.

Plan transport for a patient on added precautions

Question: A patient with suspected airborne infection must go to imaging. Which checks belong in the plan?
1. Confirm the current isolation pathway and room controls with the responsible clinical team.
2. Select the required respiratory protection and hand-hygiene steps under current facility guidance.
3. Coordinate the route, receiving area, patient source-control instructions, and equipment handling as required.
Answer: Use the current condition- and facility-specific pathway and coordinate safe transport; do not apply a generic PPE list.
Check: The CDC distinction is that Standard Precautions apply to all patients and Transmission-Based Precautions add controls when indicated.

Common misconceptions

- Standard Precautions apply only after infection is diagnosed.
- Gloves remove the need for hand hygiene.
- One PPE set is appropriate for every task and setting.
- A multidose vial makes used injection equipment safe to reuse.

Practice patterns

- For infection-control scenarios, start with Standard Precautions, then identify whether the
- stated risk requires added measures.
- For PPE questions, connect the task and expected exposure to the current facility pathway.
- For injections, verify new sterile equipment for each patient and injection and follow local
- vial-handling policy.

Official scope references

Official scope: Enhanced Tables of Specifications for the Subjects in the Nurses Licensure Examination — Professional Regulation Commission; Professional Regulatory Board of Nursing — https://www.prc.gov.ph/sites/default/files/2025-10%20%20published%20Enhanced%20TOS%20nuse.pdf

Instructional references

Instructional reference: Core Infection Prevention and Control Practices — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/core-practices/
Instructional reference: Isolation Precautions Guideline — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/precautions.html
Instructional reference: Safe Injection Practices to Prevent Transmission of Infections to Patients — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/injection-safety/hcp/clinical-guidance/
Instructional reference: CDC Isolation Precautions Guideline — Section II.H: Transport of Patients — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/prevention.html

Instructional reference: CDC Isolation Precautions Guideline — Section III: Precautions to Prevent Transmission — U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention — https://www.cdc.gov/infection-control/hcp/isolation-precautions/precautions.html

BoardPrep lesson material is original instruction. It is not an official examination document.
No claim about question frequency or examination weighting is made.